

Forever games were always mortal

There is a special smell in the air when a live-service game dies. Not burning servers. More like incense at a corporate funeral, mixed with stale energy drink and shareholder panic. Bungie has confirmed that Destiny 2's final live-service content update, Monument of Triumph, arrives on June 9, 2026, after which active development stops, though the game will be playable like the original Destiny. Guardians are not evicted. They are being moved into a museum where the gift shop still accepts premium currency.

Granny has seen this movie before. Back in my day, when a game ended, it ended because you defeated the final boss, saved the kingdom, and the cartridge went back into the cupboard. Now a game "ends" after twelve years, three currencies, roadmaps, and enough patch notes to wallpaper a modest Mumbai flat. Destiny was supposed to be a universe. Even universes need cost control.

The spicy bit is Sony's accounting masala. In 2022, Sony agreed to acquire Bungie for \$3.6 billion, explicitly citing Bungie's "world-class approach to live game services" and tech expertise. That sounded clever then, like buying the family's best pressure cooker before Diwali. Except Sony's FY2025 results now record impairment losses against Bungie's intangible and other assets totalling 120.1 billion yen, roughly the \$765 million slap being discussed across the industry.

This is the lesson everyone pretended not to know: you cannot simply acquire live-service wisdom the way my neighbour acquires air fryers. Expertise is not a DLC. Culture is not a battle pass.

The Final Shape, perversely, may have been too good at its job. It gave Destiny's decade-long Light and Darkness saga the



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kind of ending players respected. Lovely. Dangerous. Because once you give people closure, some commit the ultimate sin in live service: they leave satisfied. They touch grass. They remember spouses. They discover other icons on the console home screen. For a business model built on eternal return, a satisfying finale is sabotage with orchestral music.

So Bungie now turns to Marathon, its shiny extraction shooter, which reportedly launched but has not sold where Bungie or Sony would like, while reports indicate Destiny 3 is not in active production and layoffs are expected after Destiny 2's wind-down. Far from a pivot, that is a studio doing parkour over a canyon while carrying a piano.

The human cost is the part Granny cannot joke away, though she will try, because otherwise we all start throwing controllers at capitalism. Developers spent years building raids, weapons, worlds, economies, and traps that made us cry over space wizards. The reward for finishing the legendary thing may be a calendar invite titled "business update."

Monument of Triumph will almost certainly be bittersweet. Players will return. Screenshots will bloom. Sparrow Racing League coming back at the end feels like Bungie finally opening the locked sweets cupboard when the house is already sold. Fans asked for these things for years. Apparently the magic words were not "please" but "final update."

Yet Destiny 2's frozen future may be oddly beautiful. Not dead, exactly. Preserved. A static cathedral of loot, triumph, poor decisions, and magnificent memories. The forever game did not last forever. Of course, it didn't. Nothing does, my dear reader. Not empires, not knees, not Sony's patience. *